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Y Combinator is going all-in on AI agents, making up nearly 50% of latest batch

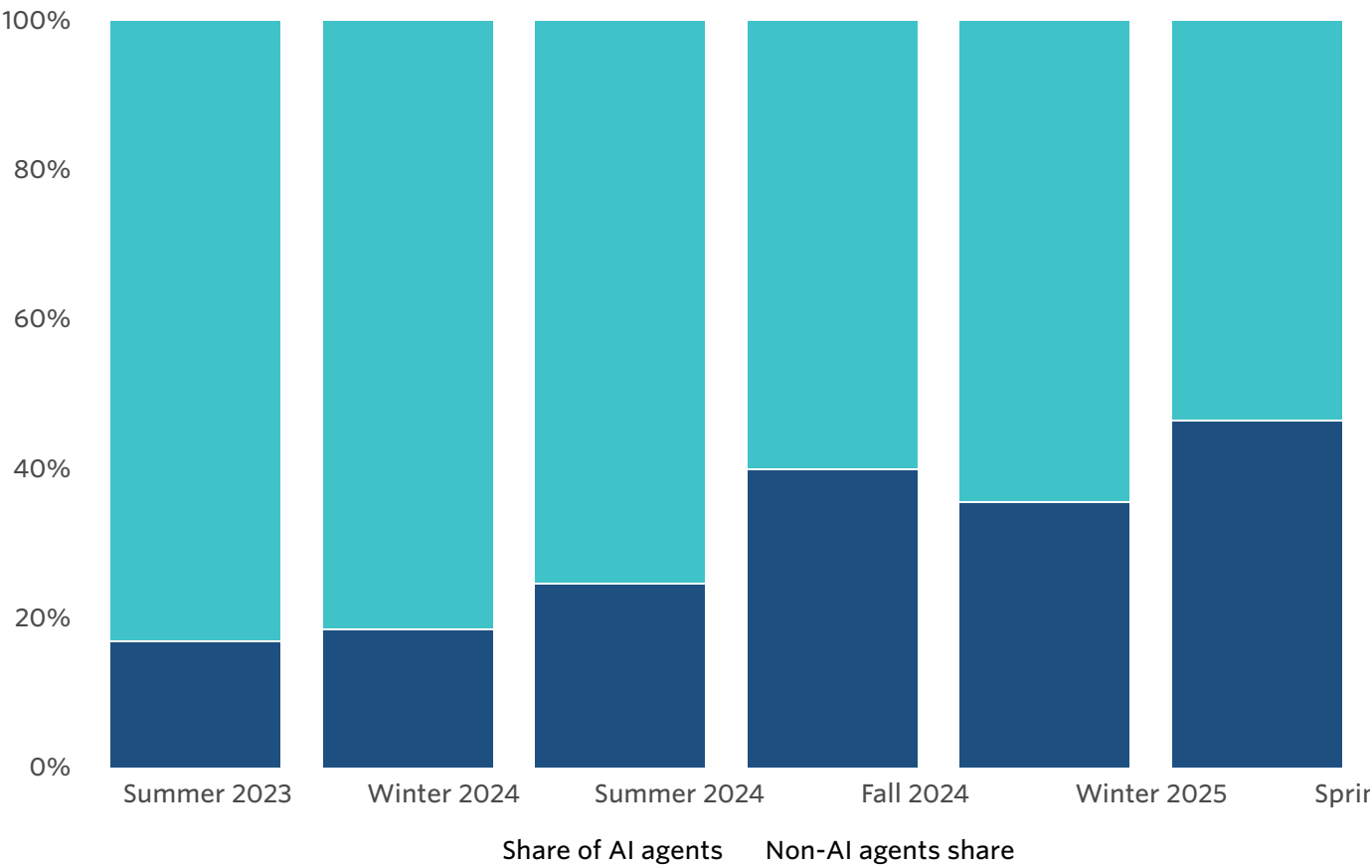
By [Jacob Robbins](#) & [Kia Kokalitcheva](#)

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Nearly half of the startups in [Y Combinator](#)'s first-ever Spring cohort were companies building or designing tools to create AI agents, continuing the famed accelerator's tendency to reflect the broader startup market's trends.

Of the 144 startups in the Spring 2025 batch, 67 are described as “AI agents” within the accelerator’s online database. That’s an uptick from YC’s last cohort, when 58 out of the 163 startups featured in its Winter 2025 batch were AI agent companies.

Agent Accelerator



Source: Y-Combinator
As of June 11, 2025



Y Combinator began to deepen its focus on AI in the last couple of years as part of the boom sparked by [OpenAI](#)’s introduction of ChatGPT. Of the 260 companies that participated in its Winter 2024 program, more than half were building or using AI technology.

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“I think people have complained about YC every year that it’s too oversaturated with X thing,” said Andy McLoughlin, managing partner at [Uncork Capital](#). “But everything now is

AI: every company we're funding, that we're looking at, that's going through YC is using AI, and the question is are they pretty good or are they really f----- good?"

And of course, some investors complain that YC startup valuations are too steep. The current excitement around AI agents and AI infrastructure has undoubtedly helped a number of the companies in this group command valuations upward of \$70 million post-money, according to investors who spoke to PitchBook.

"YC is playing a total different game," said Matt Cohen, founder and managing partner at [Ripple Ventures](#). "There's this dislocation between what we're doing our deals at and the traditional YC round. We're just not playing that game."

Continuing a trend of the last several years, many VCs at the in-person Demo Day event on Wednesday were simply there to socialize with their peers—and to celebrate the founders onstage to whom they had already written checks, as a number of the startups have already completed their fundraising. In fact, one founder in this current batch told PitchBook that they were instructed to begin fundraising a week or two ago.

But not all investors are getting stressed out. "I am going to give YC credit," said [Otherwise Fund](#) managing director Terrence Rohan. "Are they a premium pool? Yes, they are, and should there be premium prices for that? I am OK with that."

Featured image by Drew Sanders/PitchBook News

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About [Jacob Robbins](#)

Reporter Jacob Robbins covers artificial intelligence and the venture capital ecosystem for PitchBook. Based in Seattle, Jacob is originally from Massachusetts and holds dual degrees in political science and cinema studies from the American University. His work has previously appeared in Air Mail and Business Insider.



About [Kia Kokalitcheva](#)

Kia Kokalitcheva leads PitchBook's US venture capital news team and is based in San Francisco. With over a decade of experience covering Silicon Valley, startups, VCs, and the broader dealmaking world, she brings deep expertise and curiosity to the newsroom. Kia previously worked at Axios, Fortune, and VentureBeat. She holds a bachelor's degree in Political Economy from UC Berkeley, where she was a columnist for its award-winning student newspaper, The Daily Californian.

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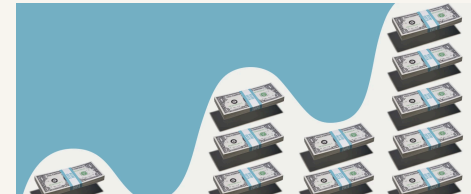


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